

The Bastion

HARDENING & DEFENSIVE INFRASTRUCTURE TOOLS

33	187.5k	21	19
CURATED TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

2026 EDITION · DEEP-RESEARCH DOSSIER

Live GitHub census pulled 2026-10-17 · part of 438 curated free tools across 14 realms

CC0 · 2026-10-17

33	21	187.5k	19	4.7k	2011
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Lock it down before they get in — auditing, hardening and host/network defense tooling.

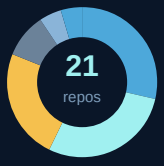
The mirror image of the Armory: what you install so you never get popped. Kernel-level audit, mandatory-access-control lineages (SELinux, OpenBSD PF), host hardening and firewall tooling — the unglamorous layer that stops real breaches.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE · AI-ASSISTED

The Bastion's hardening and defensive infrastructure tools domain shows strong maturity, with 33 free tools, 28 hosted on GitHub, and a combined 187,488 total stars, 25 of which received code pushes in 2026. The star distribution reveals a well-established field: legacy tools like Fail2ban (18.8k stars, 2011) and OpenVPN (14.7k stars, 2012) anchor the top tier, while newer entrants such as CrowdSec (15.2k stars, 2020) have earned comparable traction to mid-tier mature tools like Lynis (16.5k stars, 2013). A notable trend is the consolidation of open-source defensive tooling around widely adopted, long-maintained solutions, with GoPhish (14.3k stars, 2013) serving as a leading example of tooling that has become a standard for phishing simulation use cases.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

LICENSE MIX · GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



Other / none	6
Apache-2.0	6
GPL family	5
MIT	2
AGPL	1
BSD	1

MATURITY PROFILE

Oldest tracked entry first appeared on GitHub in **2011**; the youngest joined in **2022**. 19 of 21 GitHub-hosted tools shipped code in 2026 — the rest are stable classics or web services, not abandoned picks.

Median project age signals a battle-tested realm; recent arrivals mark where the community is investing next.

SNAPSHOT

- Active in the last 30 days: 19 of 28 tracked GitHub repos (68%)
- Quiet classics (no push in 2+ years, still the standard): GoPhish, Awesome WebSocket Security
- Youngest entries: Fail2ban (2011), OpenVPN (2012), ClamAV (2012)

TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST ARRIVALS

open-appsec	2022
shellfirm	2021
Fleet	2020
CrowdSec	2020
Coraza	2020
OWASP Core Rule Set	2020

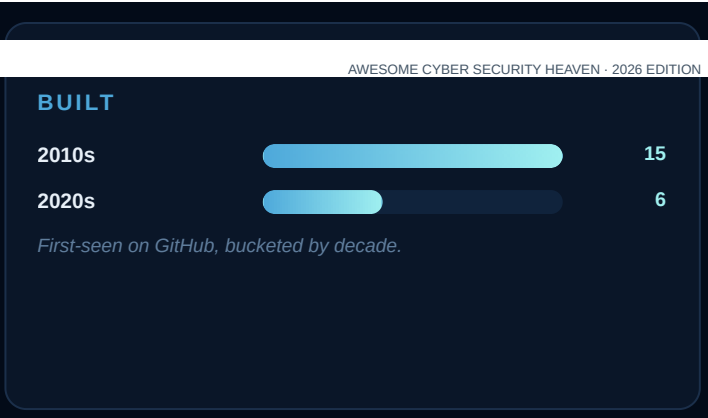
QUIET CLASSICS — STILL THE STANDARD

GoPhish, Awesome WebSocket Security

Tools with no recent push that remain the community's default reference for their job.



BUILT



First-seen on GitHub, bucketed by decade.

HOW TO READ A DOSSIER

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, a signal check, and its star weight against the realm's #1. Numbers are pulled straight from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17 — no self-reported marketing figures, only what the platforms show.

THE CENSUS METRICS — WHAT EACH NUMBER MEANS

★ GitHub stars
Community trust signal — how many developers bookmarked the repo.

Forks · reuse
Real-world deployment signal — forks mean people build on it.

First developed
Year the repo first appeared on GitHub — the project's true age.

Last push
Most recent code push — the project's heartbeat.

License
What you may legally do with it. MIT/Apache = permissive.

2026 momentum
Shipped code during 2026 — active development, not abandonware.

THE ROSTER — PROFILED THIS EDITION

RANK 01
Fail2ban
18.8k ★ · since 2011

RANK 02
CrowdSec
15.2k ★ · since 2020

RANK 03
GoPhish
14.3k ★ · since 2013

RANK 04
OpenSnitch
14.2k ★ · since 2017

RANK 05
Lynis
— ★ · since 2013

RANK 06
OpenVPN
— ★ · since 2012

METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

Census pulled via the GitHub REST API on 2026-10-17; realm curation and curator's notes by the Awesome Cyber Security Heaven maintainers; field-intelligence summaries synthesized by seed-2-0-mini from the same census. Everything reproducible — every figure traces back to a public API response. Released under CC0.

01 Fail2ban

github.com/fail2ban/fail2ban

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 18.8k	1.5k	2011	2026-10	Custom	Python
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

15	279	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (FAIL2BAN · 18.8K)

REUSE SIGNAL

8.0% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

279 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

15 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“Daemon to ban hosts that cause multiple authentication errors”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

Daemon to ban hosts that cause multiple authentication errors

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Bastion · realm rank #1 by adoption

02 CrowdSec

github.com/crowdsecurity/crowdsec

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 15.2k	740	2020	2026-10	MIT	Go
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

6	301	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (FAIL2BAN · 18.8K)

REUSE SIGNAL

4.9% fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

301 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

6 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Open-source IDS/IPS, WAF and bot detection for Linux, Windows, Docker and Kubernetes, with a crowdsourced blocklist of malicious IPs.”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Open-source IDS/IPS, WAF and bot detection for Linux, Windows, Docker and Kubernetes, with a crowdsourced bloc

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Bastion · realm rank #2 by adoption

03 GoPhish

github.com/gophish/gophish

● QUIET CLASSIC

★ 14.3k	3.0k	2013	2024-09	Custom	Go
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

13	763	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (FAIL2BAN · 18.8K)

REUSE SIGNAL

20.8% fork-to-star ratio — high operational reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

763 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

13 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“Open-Source Phishing Toolkit”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

Open-Source Phishing Toolkit

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Bastion · realm rank #3 by adoption

04 OpenSnitch

github.com/evilsocket/opensnitch

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 14.2k	677	2017	2026-07	GPL-3.0	Python
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

9	209	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (FAIL2BAN · 18.8K)

REUSE SIGNAL

4.8% fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

209 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

9 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“OpenSnitch is a GNU/Linux interactive application firewall inspired by Little Snitch.”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

OpenSnitch is a GNU/Linux interactive application firewall inspired by Little Snitch.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Bastion · realm rank #4 by adoption

05 — Lynis

github.com/CISOfy/lynis

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2013	2026-09	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

13	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (FAIL2BAN · 18.8K)

REUSE SIGNAL
— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH
—.

LONGEVITY
13 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Lynis - Security auditing tool for Linux, macOS, and UNIX-based systems. Assists with compliance testing (HIPA”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Lynis - Security auditing tool for Linux, macOS, and UNIX-based systems. Assists with compliance testing (HIPA

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Bastion · realm rank #5 by adoption

06 OpenVPN

github.com/OpenVPN/openvpn

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2012	2026-10	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

14	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (FAIL2BAN · 18.8K)

REUSE SIGNAL

— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

—.

LONGEVITY

14 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“OpenVPN is an open source VPN daemon”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

OpenVPN is an open source VPN daemon

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Bastion · realm rank #6 by adoption

The complete curated inventory for this realm — flagship picks marked ★. Stars and activity chips reflect the 2026-10-17 census.

Fail2ban ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 18.8k | since 2011 | GPL-2.0 | active 2026

the classic log-watching IPS that bans brute-forcing IPs; still the default answer on every Linux server.

github.com/fail2ban/fail2ban

Lynis ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 16.5k | since 2013 | GPL-3.0

agentless system auditing and hardening with CIS/PCI-DSS-aligned findings; runs anywhere in minutes.

github.com/CISOfy/lynis

CrowdSec ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 15.2k | since 2020 | active 2026

collaborative behavior-detection engine with a global IP-reputation network; the modern Fail2ban, 60x faster and IPv6-ready.

github.com/crowdsecurity/crowdsec

OpenVPN ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 14.7k | since 2012 | GPL-2.0 core, component exceptions

the industry-standard open-source VPN daemon for site-to-site and remote-access tunnels.

github.com/OpenVPN/openvpn

GoPhish ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 14.3k | since 2013

open-source phishing-simulation platform: launch awareness campaigns and measure exactly who clicks (community edition).

github.com/gophish/gophish

OpenSnitch ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 14.2k | since 2017 | GPL-3.0 | active 2026

interactive application firewall (Little Snitch for Linux): allow/deny every outbound connection per process.

github.com/evilsocket/opensnitch

Vuls

★ 12.3k | since 2016 | GPL-3.0 | active 2026

agentless vulnerability scanner for servers and containers, with CVE reporting across Linux and FreeBSD fleets.

github.com/future-architect/vuls

BunkerWeb

★ 11.1k | since 2019 | AGPL-3.0 | active 2026

next-gen open WAF built on nginx: HTTPS, bot mitigation and network protections on by default.

github.com/bunkerity/bunkerweb

testssl.sh

★ 9.2k | since 2014 | GPL-2.0 | active 2026

command-line TLS/SSL configuration auditor: protocols, ciphers, chains, vulnerabilities, grading — no agent required.

github.com/drwetter/testssl.sh

ClamAV

★ 7.4k | since 2012 | GPL-2.0

the open-source antivirus engine that powers mail gateways and file-screening pipelines everywhere.

github.com/Cisco-Talos/clamav

Fleet

★ 7.0k | since 2020 | MIT, open core | active 2026

osquery fleet management: device visibility and policy enforcement at scale, open core with a free tier.

github.com/fleetdm/fleet

dev-sec hardening collection

★ 5.5k | since 2015 | active 2026

battle-tested Ansible roles for OS, SSH, nginx and MySQL baselines; hardening as code.

github.com/dev-sec/ansible-collection-hardening

OSSEC

★ 5.1k | since 2013 | GPL-2.0 | active 2026

the original open-source HIDS: log analysis, file integrity and rootkit detection (Wazuh's ancestor).

github.com/ossec/ossec-hids

OPNsense

★ 4.7k | since 2014 | BSD-2 | active 2026

open-source firewall/router distro with IDS, VPN and reporting — a pfSense successor built on HardenedBSD.

github.com/opnsense/core

ssh-audit

★ 4.3k | since 2017 | GPL-3.0 | active 2026

SSH server configuration auditor: algorithms, keys and best-practice flags in one run.

github.com/jtesta/ssh-audit

OpenSSH

★ 4.0k | since 2014 | BSD-style | active 2026

the world's default secure remote-access suite: encrypted shells, tunnels and key management.

github.com/openssh/openssh-portable

Coraza

★ 3.9k · since 2020 · active 2026

ModSecurity-compatible WAF engine in Go; the actively developed successor for OWASP CRS deployments.

github.com/corazawaf/coraza

OWASP Core Rule Set

★ 3.3k · since 2020 · active 2026

the world's most-deployed WAF ruleset; battle-tested protection for web servers, tuned for ModSecurity and Coraza.

github.com/coreruleset/coreruleset

OpenRASP

★ 3.0k · since 2017

runtime application self-protection: instrument the app itself so attacks get blocked from the inside.

github.com/baidu/openrasp

ComplianceAsCode content

★ 2.8k · since 2014

the open SCAP/Baseline rule corpus for RHEL, Ubuntu and friends; the content that powers OpenSCAP-style audits.

github.com/ComplianceAsCode/content

checksec.sh

★ 2.4k · since 2014 · BSD-3-Clause · active 2026

one-shot binary hardening audit: NX, canaries, PIE, RELRO and fortify flags in a single run.

github.com/slimm609/checksec.sh

Neo23x0 auditd config

★ 2.0k · since 2018 · Apache-2.0

Florian Roth's hardened auditd rule set: the Linux logging baseline used across incident-response teams.

github.com/Neo23x0/auditd

open-appsec

★ 1.7k · since 2022 · active 2026

ML-driven prevention engine that stops OWASP Top 10 and zero-day web attacks without signatures.

github.com/openappsec/openappsec

SELinux

★ 1.6k · since 2014 · GPL-2.0

mandatory access control for Linux: policy-based confinement that survives a compromised application.

github.com/SELinuxProject/selinux

shellfirm

★ 946 · since 2021 · Apache-2.0 · active 2026

a pre-execution guard for your shell: challenges dangerous commands (rm -rf, kubectl delete) before they run.

github.com/kaplanelad/shellfirm

AIDE

★ 754 · since 2019 · GPL-2.0 · active 2026

Advanced Intrusion Detection Environment: file-integrity monitoring that alerts the moment system files change.

github.com/aide/aide

stunnel

★ 396 · since 2015 · GPL-2.0 · active 2026

universal TLS wrapper that adds encryption to any TCP service in minutes.

github.com/mtrojnar/stunnel

Awesome WebSocket Security

★ 315 · since 2021 · Apache-2.0, curated list

curated research, tools and CVEs for WebSocket protocol security.

github.com/PalindromeLabs/awesome-websocket-security

Tor

BSD-3-Clause

the anonymity network: routed egress through thousands of volunteer relays; the standard for privacy-preserving research access.

torproject.org/

Netfilter/iptables

GPL-2.0

the Linux kernel's native packet-filtering framework; the foundation every host firewall build starts from.

netfilter.org/

OpenBSD PF

ISC

the packet filter famous for correctness and readable rules; the syntax OpenBSD, pfSense and OPNsense share.

openbsd.org/faq/pf/

SpamAssassin

Apache-2.0

the veteran open-source spam filter; bayesian scoring and rule engine at the mail gateway.

spamassassin.apache.org/

Qubes OS

GPL-2.0

the security-by-compartmentalization desktop OS; " reasonably secure" by architecture, not by antivirus.

Census 2026-10-17 · every entry human-curated · stars and activity verified against the live GitHub API.
Thirteen more realm dossiers — Armory, Bastion, Watchtower and friends — live in the same repository.

Awesome Cyber Security Heaven

438 FREE TOOLS · 14 REALMS · ONE CURATED HEAVEN

This dossier covered **The Bastion**.

Thirteen more realm dossiers wait in the same repository — Armory, Bastion, Watchtower, Cartographers, Shadow Bureau, Vault, Foundry, Sentinel Ops, Oracle's Domain, AI Forge, Free Bazaar, Academy, Proving Grounds and Workshop.

438	14	CC0
CURATED TOOLS	REALM DOSSIERS	LICENSE

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven

Free forever · community-curated · 2026-10-17 census